

**KMVTECH EDUCATION****CEL1 · Module 2****International framework**

Lesson: Global and regional instruments

Student Lesson Notes

Study with the online lessons. Prefer primary sources (Constitution, statutes, treaties, cases). © KMVTECH Education · September 2026.

---

**1. CORE IDEA**

Key global instruments include the Rio Declaration, UNFCCC and Paris Agreement (climate), Convention on Biological Diversity, CITES, Basel Convention (hazardous waste), Stockholm Convention (POPs) and the Aarhus-inspired access principles. Soft-law and SDG frameworks also influence national policy.

Africa has developed regional environmental instruments and the African Convention on the Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources. Transboundary resources (water, wildlife, pollution) require cooperative regimes.

Treaties create State obligations of prevention, cooperation, reporting and, in some cases, liability. Implementation remains primarily national.

- Climate change and biodiversity loss have elevated the urgency and the legal density of the international framework.

## 2. DETAILED RULES AND APPLICATION

Example: a proposal to trade in an endangered species engages CITES listing, national implementing legislation and possible regional enforcement cooperation.

Map the relevant treaty or soft-law instrument, then check Uganda's ratification status and domestic implementing measures.

### 3. UGANDA / PRACTICE, METHOD AND TRAPS

Uganda is party to the major environmental conventions and participates in climate and biodiversity negotiations. Domestic law must give effect to these commitments; courts increasingly refer to them in interpretation.

Exam trap: citing a treaty as directly enforceable without checking ratification and domestication, or ignoring the cooperative nature of transboundary obligations.

Method: identify the environmental issue → select the governing international instrument(s) → confirm Uganda's status → link to domestic duties and any reporting or compliance mechanism.

Sets the external frame for Uganda's domestic regime.

## SELF-TEST QUESTIONS

Attempt these before the platform practice quiz.

1. Name four major global environmental treaties.
2. What is the Paris Agreement's core aim?
3. Why do transboundary resources need cooperation?
4. How do soft-law instruments influence national law?
5. What must a State typically do after ratification?
6. Why check domestication status?

**Exam tip:** Treaty + ratification + domestic measures.

## CHECKLIST BEFORE YOU LEAVE THIS LESSON

- I can state the main instrument(s) or Cap number.
- I can explain the core rule in my own words.
- I can apply the rule to a short Uganda / regional fact pattern.
- I know the common exam trap for this topic.
- I know how this lesson links to the next module.

**Next step:** Complete the online practice quiz for this lesson, then continue on the platform.